Heuristic Evaluation

Part I: Your Name

Lisa Cangialosi, 314809

Part II: Project Description

The project I'm analyzing involves developing an application called "Sport Connect" that facilitates connecting individuals interested in organizing sports games, enabling users to find like-minded individuals at their skill level for various sports activities.

Part III: Evaluation Execution

I conducted a heuristic evaluation of the low-fi paper prototype developed by another group, engaging in an in-person session. Within their team, one member served as the facilitator, offering contextual briefings and describing the three tasks, while another simulated the computer by manipulating paper representations of various screens and features (like pop ups). To complete the assigned tasks, I navigated through the prototype with their assistance, exploring the application.
Throughout the evaluation, I maintained written notes and ensured video documentation of the session. I occasionally raised questions regarding elements challenging to comprehend due to the paper-based graphic representations and lack of color, promptly addressed by the facilitating team member.

Part IV: List of Violations

1. H2 Match between system and the real world
   Where: "New Match" and "Search Match" buttons on the home page
   What: They both look for a new match, but the New one creates a new game while the Search one looks for existing ones to participate in.
   Why: The terminology is unclear as both buttons serve the same function of initiating a new match and the distinction lies in whether the game already exists or not. However, this difference isn't adequately conveyed through the button labels, in fact users might think the second button is intended for reviewing previously created matches (like a "my matches" list), rather than for initiating new ones.
   Severity: 2

2. H10 Help and Documentation
   Where: “New Match” page
   What: Level field
   Why: It is not clear how the level is given, based on which scale and why it is not changeable.
   Severity: 2

3. H4 Consistency and standards
   Where: “New match” page
   What: Players field
   Why: When you select the sport you also select the number of players because in the sport options the user has “Football 5v5” but also “Football 7v7” but then you select the number of players in the dedicated field. Maybe it could be useful in the context you already know some players interested in joining, but in that case the field’s name should be “needed/remaining players”.
   Severity: 3

4. H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design
   Where: “New match” page + “Next Match”
   What: Start and End fields
   Why: Each row consists of the title of the field along with its respective value, except for the 'start' and 'end' fields, which are both displayed within a single row.
   Severity: 1

5. H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use
   Where: “New Match” page + “Search Match” page
   What: Location flied
   Why: The user's options are limited to specific predetermined locations or their current one. It could be beneficial to allow users the ability to input or search for an address as well.
   Severity: 2

6. H1 Visibility of system status
   Where: Home page
   What: the user doesn’t get feedback about creating a match
   Why: After you fill out the form and hit "create" to submit, the app doesn't show any message to confirm if it worked or not. Adding a message after you create a match could be helpful (also because the user cannot see his matches anywhere, just the next one).
   Severity: 3

7. H5 Error prevention
   Where: “New Match” page
   What: There’s no indication about mandatory fields
   Why: It'd be better to show which fields are required and which ones aren't when creating a

new match because in this way, there's less chance that the user doesn’t include all the necessary information and fails to create a match.
Severity: 1

8. H1 Visibility of system status
   Where: Home page
   What: The user doesn’t know how the process of creating a new match ended up if they press on the back button
   Why: It might be useful to display a message, like "the match has not been created," if the user navigates back to the home page before hitting the create button.
   Severity: 1

9. H3 User control and freedom
   Where: Home Page
   What: The user has not a list of the matches he selected
   Why: The user has control over managing only their next match. If they create a match scheduled further ahead than their existing ones, it doesn't become visible, so, consequently, they can't delete a match that isn't the immediate upcoming one.
   Severity: 3

10. H2 Match between system and the real world
    Where: “Next match” page
    What: “Confirm” button
    Why: The user would expect that the confirm button is used to certify something, instead in this case it’s just a back button.
    Severity: 2

11. H4 Consistency and standards
    Where: “Next match” page
    What: “Confirm” button
    Why: Throughout the whole application the back function is implemented with an arrow icon, in this case it’s done by a button with the label “confirm”
    Severity: 2

12. H1 Visibility of system status
    Where: “Next Match” page
    What: “Quit” button
    Why: The user doesn’t get any feedback after pressing the “Quit” button, the application just turns back to the home page
    Severity: 2

13. H3 User control and freedom
    Where: “Next Match” page
    What “Quit” button
    Why: When the user clicks the Quit button, the function is immediately executed without requesting confirmation. Consequently, if it's triggered accidentally, there's no opportunity for recovery or undoing the action before it’s too late.
    Severity: 3

14. H1 Visibility of system status
    Where: “Participate” page
    What: “Confirm” button
    Why: The user doesn’t get any feedback after pressing the “Confirm” button, the application just turns back to the home page
    Severity: 2

15. H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design
    Where: Dropdown men in the home page
    What: “Insert” and “Manage” “fields”
    Why: I would have expected to find only account-related functions in the dropdown menu, and to have a link to the option of inserting fields on the homepage.
    Severity: 1

16. H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design
    Where: “Insert field” page
    What: price slot field
    Why: It seems that the user can change only the currency when he can also change the price
    Severity: 1

17. H10 Help and Documentation
    Where: “Insert field” page
    What: Open fields
    Why: Those are three field: opening hours, closing hours and day of the week and it’s not clear at first sight.
    Severity: 1

18. H2 Match between system and the real world
    Where: “Manage fields” page
    What: free/occupied symbols
    Why: In this app, the "X" symbol denotes the field being open but unbooked, while the circular symbol can signify two things: either the field is closed or it's occupied, discernible by color. Based on general app usage, I'd have expected the "X" symbol to represent a closed or occupied

field and another symbol to indicate an available field.
Severity: 3

19. H2 Match between system and the real world
    Where: “Settings” button
    What: it redirects you to the insert field page to modify the field’s information
    Why: I would expect other type of settings based on general experience on mobile application, instead I would expect this function to be called “Modify”
    Severity: 2

20. H4 Consistency and standards
    Where: “Setting” button
    What: it redirects you to the insert field page to modify the field’s information
    Why: There are 2 different paths that implement two different functions that end up on the same “Insert field” page
    Severity: 2

Part V: Summary and Recommendations

Report in the table below the total number of identified violations.

Heuristic	**# violations**
H1: Visibility of system status	4
H2: Match between system and the real world	4
H3: User control and freedom	2
H4: Consistency and standards	3
H5: Error prevention	1
H6: Recognition rather than recall	0
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	1
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	3
H9: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors	0
H10: Help and documentation	2
HN: Non-heuristic issue	0

Overall, I find this project to be a comprehensive application that effectively satisfies the needs of this group. One positive aspect is the user-friendly design, making it easy to comprehend the steps for performing the three tasks, even for users less familiar with technology than myself.

My suggestion for improvement involves modifying the layout of the calendar used to establish the opening and closing hours of a field. Additionally, I propose incorporating a section enabling users to manage all their matches, not only the upcoming one. Finally, integrating feedback mechanisms across the entire application would be beneficial.